## 2.4 Rubber

Rubber is also known as Elastomer. It is produced as a natural product from rubber trees and also manufactured by chemical processes. The former is known as natural rubber and the latter is synthetic rubber. Natural rubber has high strength and good resistance to tear as well as flexure. However it is easily affected by solvents.

It is widely used in the construction industry, for sealing, shock absorbtion, electrical insulation, fire-proof insulation, in expansion joints, etc.




### 2.4.1 Uses of Rubber as building materials

The general uses of rubber as a building materials are as follows:

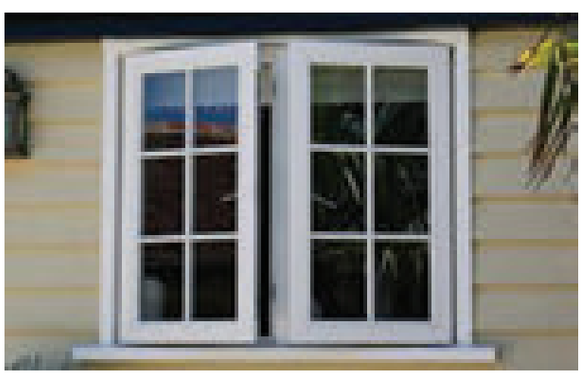
1. Rubber is used as a gasket to make doors and windows air tight.
2. Rubber latex is used for bonding rubber to metal, wood and similar surfaces.
3. It is used as shock absorber in construction work like bridge, etc.
4. Rubber is used as a sealent in water-retaining structures.
5. Rubber can be used as a joint filler.
6. Rubber is also used for flooring in buildings.
7. Rubber coatings and linings are used for corrosion protection in offshore engineering.
8. Rubber can be used as sound absorbers.

## 2.5 Unplasticized Polyvinyl Chloride (UPVC)

**R**egular PVC (Poly vinyl Chloride) is a common, strong, but light weight plastic used in construction. It is made softer and more flexible by the addition of plasticizers. If plasticizers are not added, it is known as UPVC (Unplasticized Polyvinyl Chloride).

### 2.5.1 Advantages of UPVC

- Gives perfect insulation (from heat and cold).
- Highly hygienic.
- No maintenance required.
- Sound proof.
- Available in various colour and sizes.
- Not affected by atmospheric agencies.
- Easy to clean.
- Safe and easy to operate.
- Not affected by insects.





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